Specification of the controlled designation of origin "VOLNAY"

approved by decree no. 2011-1535 of 14 November 2011, JORF of 16 November 2011

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Volnay", initially recognised by the decree of 9 September 1937.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

1° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by the term "premier cru" for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for this term in the present specification.

2° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by the term "premier cru" and followed by the name of one of the climats listed below, for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for the term "premier cru" in the present specification.

3° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be followed by the name of one of the climats listed below, for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for the term "premier cru" in the present specification.

LIST OF CLIMATS	
– "Carelle sous la Chapelle"; – "Champans"; – "Clos de l'Audignac"; – "Clos de la Barre"; – "Clos de la Bousse-d'Or"; – "Clos de la Cave des Ducs"; – "Clos de la Chapelle"; – "Clos de la Rougeotte"; – "Clos des 60 Ouvrées"; – "Clos des Chênes"; – "Clos des Ducs"; – "Clos du Château des Ducs"; – "Clos du Verseuil"; – "En Chevret"; – "Frémiets";	– "Frémiets - Clos de la Rougeotte"; – "La Gigotte"; – "Lassolle"; – "Le Ronceret"; – "Le Village"; – "Les Angles"; – "Les Brouillards"; – "Les Caillerets"; – "Les Lurets"; – "Les Mitans"; – "Pitures Dessus"; – "Robardelle"; – "Santenots"; – "Taille Pieds".

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Volnay" is reserved for still red wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes of the Côte-d'Or department: Meursault and Volnay, on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2024.

2° – Delimited parcel area

a) – The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 16 September 1982.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

b) – Wines eligible for the term "premier cru" come exclusively from vines situated within the specific delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 20 September 1984 and of 9 and 10 November 2005.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes, on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2024:

- Côte-d'Or department: Agencourt, Aloxe-Corton, Ancey, Arcenant, Argilly, Autricourt, Auxey-Duresses, Baubigny, Beaune, Belan-sur-Ource, Bévy, Bissey-la-Côte, Bligny-lès-Beaune, Boncourt-le-Bois, Bouix, Bouze-lès-Beaune, Brion-sur-Ource, Brochon, Cérilly, Chambœuf, Chambolle-Musigny, Channay, Charrey-sur-Seine, Chassagne-Montrachet, Châtillon-sur-Seine, Chaumont-le-Bois, Chaux, Chenôve, Chevannes, Chorey-lès-Beaune, Collonges-lès-Bévy, Combertault, Comblanchien, Corcelles-les-Arts, Corcelles-les-Monts, Corgoloin, Cormot-le-Grand, Corpeau, Couchey, Curley, Curtil-Vergy, Daix, Dijon, Ebaty, Echevronne, Epernay-sous-Gevrey, L'Etang-Vergy, Etrochey, Fixin, Flagey-Echézeaux, Flavignerot, Fleurey-sur-Ouche, Fussey, Gerland, Gevrey-Chambertin, Gilly-lès-Cîteaux, Gomméville, Grancey-sur-Ource, Griselles, Ladoix-Serrigny, Lantenay, Larrey, Levernois, Magny-lès-Villers, Mâlain, Marcenay, Marey-lès-Fussey, Marsannay-la-Côte, Massingy, Mavilly-Mandelot, Meloisey, Merceuil, Messanges, Meuilley, Meursanges, Molesme, Montagny-lès-Beaune, Monthelie, Montliot-et-Courcelles, Morey-Saint-Denis, Mosson, Nantoux, Nicey, Noiron-sur-Seine, Nolay, Nuits-Saint-Georges, Obtrée, Pernand-Vergelesses, Perrigny-lès-Dijon, Plombières-lès-Dijon, Poinçon-lès-Larrey, Pommard, Pothières, Premeaux-Prissey, Prusly-sur-Ource, Puligny-Montrachet, Quincey, Reulle-Vergy, La Rochepot, Ruffey-lès-Beaune, Saint-Aubin, Saint-Bernard, Saint-Philibert, Saint-Romain, Sainte-Colombe-sur-Seine, Sainte-Marie-la-Blanche, Santenay, Savigny-lès-Beaune, Segrois, Tailly, Talant, Thoires, Valforêt (for the part of the territory corresponding to the former commune of Clémencey), Vannaire, Vauchignon, Velars-sur-Ouche, Vertault, Vignoles, Villars-Fontaine, Villebichot, Villedieu, Villers-la-Faye, Villers-Patras, Villy-le-Moutier, Vix, Vosne-Romanée and Vougeot;

- Rhône department: Alix, Anse, L'Arbresle, Les Ardillats, Arnas, Bagnols, Beaujeu, Belleville, Belmont-d'Azergues, Blacé, Le Breuil, Bully, Cercié, Chambost-Allières, Chamelet, Charentay, Charnay, Châtillon, Chazay-d'Azergues, Chénas, Chessy, Chiroubles, Cogny, Corcelles-en-Beaujolais, Denicé, Dracé, Emeringes, Fleurie, Frontenas, Gleizé, Juliénas, Jullié, Lacenas, Lachassagne, Lancié, Lantignié, Le Perréon, Légny, Létra, Limas, Lozanne, Lucenay, Marchampt, Marcy, Moiré, Montmelas-Saint-Sorlin, Morancé, Odenas, Pommiers, Porte des Pierres Dorées, Quincié-en-Beaujolais, Régnié-Durette, Rivolet, Saint-Clément-sur-Valsonne, Saint-Cyr-le-Chatoux, Saint-Didier-sur-Beaujeu, Saint-Etienne-des-Oullières, Saint-Etienne-la-Varenne, Saint-Germain-sur-l'Arbresle, Saint-Georges-de-Reneins, Saint-Germain-Nuelles, Saint-Jean-des-Vignes, Saint-Julien, Saint-Just-d'Avray, Saint-Lager, Saint-Romain-de-Popey, Saint-Vérand, Sainte-Paule, Salles-Arbuissonnas-en-Beaujolais, Sarcey, Taponas, Ternand, Theizé, Val d'Oingt, Vaux-en-Beaujolais, Vauxrenard, Vernay, Villefranche-sur-Saône, Ville-sur-Jarnioux, Villié-Morgon, Vindry-sur-Turdine (for the part of the territory corresponding to the former communes of Dareizé, Les Olmes and Saint-Loup);

- Saône-et-Loire department: Aluze, Ameugny, Azé, Barizey, Beaumont-sur-Grosne, Berzé-la-Ville, Berzé-le-Châtel, Bissey-sous-Cruchaud, Bissy-la-Mâconnaise, Bissy-sous-Uxelles, Bissy-sur-Fley, Blanot, Bonnay, Bouzeron, Boyer, Bray, Bresse-sur-Grosne, Burgy, Burnand, Bussières, Buxy, Cersot, Chagny, Chaintré, Chalon-sur-Saône, Chamilly, Champagny-sous-Uxelles, Champforgeuil, Chânes, Change, Chapaize, La Chapelle-de-Bragny, La Chapelle-de-Guinchay, La Chapelle-sous-Brancion, Charbonnières, Chardonnay, La Charmée, Charnay-lès-Mâcon, Charrecey, Chasselas, Chassey-le-Camp, Château, Châtenoy-le-Royal, Chaudenay, Cheilly-lès-Maranges, Chenôves, Chevagny-lès-Chevrières, Chissey-lès-Mâcon, Clessé, Cluny, Cormatin, Cortambert, Cortevaix, Couches, Crêches-sur-Saône, Créot, Cruzille, Culles-les-Roches, Curtil-sous-Burnand, Davayé, Demigny, Dennevy, Dezize-lès-Maranges, Donzy-le-Pertuis, Dracy-le-Fort, Dracy-lès-Couches, Epertully, Etrigny, Farges-

lès-Chalon, Farges-lès-Mâcon, Flagy, Fleurville, Fley, Fontaines, Fragnes-la-Loyère (for the part of the territory corresponding to the former commune of La Loyère), Fuissé, Genouilly, Germagny, Givry, Granges, Grevilly, Hurigny, Igé, Jalogny, Jambles, Jugy, Jully-lès-Buxy, La Vineuse-sur-Frégande (for the part of the territory corresponding to the former communes of Donzy-le-National, La Vineuse and Massy), Lacrost, Laives, Laizé, Lalheue, Leynes, Lournand, Lugny, Mâcon, Malay, Mancey, Martailly-lès-Brancion, Massilly, Mellecey, Mercurey, Messey-sur-Grosne, Milly-Lamartine, Montagny-lès-Buxy, Montbellet, Montceaux-Ragny, Moroges, Nanton, Ozenay, Paris-l'Hôpital, Péronne, Pierreclos, Plottes, Préty, Prissé, Pruzilly, Remigny, La Roche-Vineuse, Romanèche-Thorins, Rosey, Royer, Rully, Saint-Albain, Saint-Ambreuil, Saint-Amour-Bellevue, Saint-Boil, Saint-Clément-sur-Guye, Saint-Denis-de-Vaux, Saint-Désert, Saint-Gengoux-de-Scissé, Saint-Gengoux-le-National, Saint-Germain-lès-Buxy, Saint-Gervais-sur-Couches, Saint-Gilles, Saint-Jean-de-Trézy, Saint-Jean-de-Vaux, Saint-Léger-sur-Dheune, Saint-Mard-de-Vaux, Saint-Martin-Belle-Roche, Saint-Martin-du-Tartre, Saint-Martin-sous-Montaigu, Saint-Maurice-de-Satonnay, Saint-Maurice-des-Champs, Saint-Maurice-lès-Couches, Saint-Pierre-de-Varennes, Saint-Rémy, Saint-Sernin-du-Plain, Saint-Symphorien-d'Ancelles, Saint-Vallerin, Saint-Vérand, Saint-Ythaire, Saisy, La Salle, Salornay-sur-Guye, Sampigny-lès-Maranges, Sancé, Santilly, Sassangy, Saules, Savigny-sur-Grosne, Sennecey-le-Grand, Senozan, Sercy, Serrières, Sigy-le-Châtel, Sologny, Solutré-Pouilly, Taizé, Tournus, Uchizy, Varennes-lès-Mâcon, Vaux-en-Pré, Vergisson, Vers, Verzé, Le Villars, Vinzelles and Viré;

- Yonne department: Aigremont, Annay-sur-Serin, Arcy-sur-Cure, Asquins, Augy, Auxerre, Avallon, Bazarnes, Beine, Bernouil, Béru, Bessy-sur-Cure, Bleigny-le-Carreau, Censy, Chablis, Champlay, Champs-sur-Yonne, Chamvres, La Chapelle-Vaupelteigne, Charentenay, Châtel-Gérard, Chemilly-sur-Serein, Cheney, Chevannes, Chichée, Chitry, Collan, Coulangeron, Coulanges-la-Vineuse, Courgis, Cruzy-le-Châtel, Dannemoine, Deux-Rivières, Dyé, Epineuil, Escamps, Escolives-Sainte-Camille, Fleys, Fontenay-près-Chablis, Gy-l'Evêque, Héry, Irancy, Island, Joigny, Jouancy, Junay, Jussy, Lichères-près-Aigremont, Lignorelles, Ligny-le-Châtel, Lucy-sur-Cure, Maligny, Mélisey, Merry-Sec, Migé, Molay, Molosmes, Montholon (for the part of the territory corresponding to the former communes of Champvallon, Villiers-sur-Tholon and Volgré), Montigny-la-Resle, Mouffy, Moulins-en-Tonnerois, Nitry, Noyers, Ouanne, Paroy-sur-Tholon, Pasilly, Pierre-Perthuis, Poilly-sur-Serein, Pontigny, Préhy, Quenne, Roffey, Rouvray, Saint-Bris-le-Vineux, Saint-Cyr-les-Colons, Saint-Père, Sainte-Pallaye, Sainte-Vertu, Sarry, Senan, Serrigny, Tharoiseau, Tissey, Tonnerre, Tronchoy, Val-de-Mercy, Vallan, Venouse, Venoy, Vermenton, Vézannes, Vézelay, Vézinnes, Villeneuve-Saint-Salves, Villy, Vincelles, Vincelottes, Viviers and Yrouerre.

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

The wines come from the following varieties:

- main variety: pinot noir N;

- accessory varieties: chardonnay B, pinot blanc B, pinot gris G.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

The accessory varieties are authorised only as mixed plantings within the vines. Their total proportion is limited to 15 % within each parcel.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density

- The vines have a minimum planting density of 9,000 plants per hectare, with a spacing between rows less than or equal to 1.25 metres and a spacing between plants within the same row greater than or equal to 0.50 metre;

- The vines may be planted “en foule” (randomly, without rows), provided that the minimum planting density is respected and the spacing between plants is greater than 0.50 metre.

b) – Pruning rules

The wines come from vines pruned according to the following provisions:

GENERAL PROVISIONS
The vines are pruned with a maximum of 8 free eyes per plant: – either short pruning (vines trained as Royat cordon, bilateral cordon, gobelet and fan); – or single Guyot long pruning.
PARTICULAR PROVISIONS
The period for establishing the cordon is limited to 2 years. During this period, double Guyot pruning, with a maximum of 5 free eyes on each cane, is authorised. Single Guyot pruning may be adapted: – with a 2nd spur allowing the position of the cane to be alternated from one year to the next; – with a cane shortened to a maximum of 3 free eyes and a spur limited to 2 free eyes. Whatever the pruning method, the vines may be pruned with additional free eyes provided that, at the phenological stage corresponding to 11 or 12 leaves, the number of fruit-bearing shoots of the year per plant is less than or equal to the number of free eyes defined in the pruning rules.

c) – Trellising and foliage height rules

- The height of trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, set at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper trimming limit;

- When the vines are not trained in gobelet, they must be raised on a stake or trellised; the trellising is maintained;

- When the vines are planted “en foule”, they are trained on stakes.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is set at 9,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment, which constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir:

- any substantial modification of the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin is prohibited, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works;

- chemical or mechanical weeding of the headlands is prohibited, with the exception of one plough width along the row ends, for mechanical weeding only;

- in parcels producing wines eligible for the term “premier cru”, weeding with chemical products is prohibited, including biocontrol products.

b) – Vine plantings and replacements are carried out with healthy plant material that has undergone hot-water treatment.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness.

b) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest

The harvest is protected from rain during its transport and on its reception.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

The sugar content of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume of the wines meet the following characteristics:

	MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)	**MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
AOC “Volnay”	180	10.5 %
Wines eligible for the term “premier cru”	189	11 %

VIII. – Yields – Entry into production

1° – Yield and limit yield

The yield and limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code are set at:

	YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)	**LIMIT YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)**
AOC “Volnay”	50	58
Wines eligible for the term “premier cru”	48	56

2° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Blending of varieties

Wines produced from parcels with mixed plantings are vinified by blending the grapes.

b) – Malolactic fermentation

At the packaging stage, the wines have a maximum malic acid content of 0.4 gram per litre.

c) – Analytical standards

Finished wines, ready to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, have a maximum fermentable sugar content (glucose + fructose) of 2 grams per litre.

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments

- Subtractive enrichment techniques (TSE) are authorised within the limit of a concentration rate of 10 %;

- The use of pieces of wood is prohibited;

- After enrichment, the wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13.5 %;

- After enrichment, wines eligible for the term “premier cru” do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 14 %.

e) – Prohibited equipment

Continuous presses are prohibited.

f) – Vat capacity

Every operator has an overall vat capacity (vinification and storage) equivalent to at least 150 % of the volume of wine vinified for the previous year’s harvest, as entered either on the harvest declaration, pro rata to the change in the holding’s area in production, or on the production declaration.

g) – Upkeep of the cellar and equipment

The cellar and the equipment are well maintained; this is reflected in particular by:

- general hygiene of the elaboration premises, with general cleanliness, well-maintained floors, adequate drainage and a surface avoiding stagnation;

- harmlessness of the equipment and products coming into contact with the wine;

- separation and specificity of the premises: premises without the same functions must be separated, such as storage areas for plant-protection products, cleaning products or hydrocarbons, from the premises for vinification, ageing and storage of dry goods (corks, cartons);

- management of wine effluents: effluents must be removed as quickly as possible from foodstuff premises and deposited in well-maintained containers that are easy to clean and can be closed; waste storage areas must be kept clean; waste must be disposed of hygienically and in an environmentally friendly manner; a waste storage and removal area must be provided;

- absence of hazardous or odorous substances in the vinification, ageing and storage premises (odour).

h) – Ageing

- The wines are aged at least until 15 June of the year following that of the harvest;

- The temperature of the containers during the ageing phase is controlled and less than or equal to 25 °C.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- the reports of analyses carried out before or after packaging.

These reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of a protected storage place for wines packaged in unlabelled bottles, with a temperature of between 5 °C and 22 °C.

4° – Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

At the end of the ageing period, the wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 30 June of the year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area is situated in the “Côte de Beaune” vineyard, a linear relief stretching for about 25 kilometres in a general north-east/south-west direction. This relief of tectonic origin separates the limestone plateaux of the “Hautes Côtes” to the west, at an altitude of between 400 metres and 500 metres, from the Bresse plain to the east, a Tertiary rift valley whose altitude, level with the “Côte”, is close to 250 metres.

The relief is cut by erosion into valleys draining the plateau of the “Hautes Côtes” as well as small “combes”, dry valleys that are sometimes barely marked, creating slopes with varied exposures. The village, surrounded by the vineyard, is itself set at the outlet of a small combe.

The vineyard is established on the front of the “Côte”. The geographical area extends over the territory of the communes of Volnay and Meursault, south of the town of Beaune, in the Côte-d’Or department, in Burgundy. The relief of the “Côte”, with a difference in height of about 150 metres, exposes Jurassic sedimentary formations. At the foot of the slope, Callovian (Middle Jurassic) platy limestones appear and, in the upper part of the slopes, Oxfordian (Upper Jurassic) marls (clayey limestones) outcrop. The marl-limestone substratum is often masked by spreads mixing scree with clays and silts resulting from the weathering of the subsoil and the overlying reliefs. The nature of the spreads depends on their position on the slope. Very stony and thin at the top of the slope, on the marls, they are richer in fine particles and thicker on the piedmont (a few decimetres to 1 metre). The soils are little developed,

generally carbonated, thin and free-draining. Their characteristics vary according to their topographic position. Rather stony and lean at the top of the slope, they are deeper and clayey, sometimes slightly decarbonated at the surface, on the shelves and the piedmont.

The parcels delimited for the harvesting of the grapes are situated on the Oxfordian marl substratum for most of the territory, and on the Callovian platy limestones at the foot of the slope. The substratum is most often masked by a few decimetres of clayey colluvium, ensuring both efficient drainage and good fertility.

The climate is dominated by a cool oceanic tendency, disturbed by continental or southern influences channelled along the Rhône–Saône axis. Rainfall is moderate and well distributed over the whole year (about 750 millimetres per year). The "Côte", east of the Morvan massif and the Burgundian plateaux, benefits from climatic shelter resulting in a thermal advantage as well as a rainfall deficit that is notable for the region and conducive to quality viticulture.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

According to a study by Pierre FORGEOT, the appearance of the vine in the "Côte de Beaune" region dates back to the 2nd century BC.

The village of Volnay was built in the Middle Ages around the castle of the former Counts of Burgundy, who already owned a vineyard there. The Dukes of Burgundy, later established in Dijon, kept these possessions. Although the castle itself has disappeared, there remain many traces of this ducal history in the place names.

From the 15th century, the so-called "Beaune" wines were distributed throughout Europe. They were the emblem of the Duchy of Burgundy at its height. They were red wines, the "pinots vermeils", low in tannin and heady, the only ones able to travel.

In the 18th century, the négociant-éleveur trade developed in the Burgundy region, giving the wines of Burgundy a new image and organising their wide distribution on a European scale. The "Côte de Beaune" supplied "fine wines" to the négociant houses of Beaune, which held a large share of the market. At that time, the wines of "Volnay" enjoyed a great reputation and were the jewel of the "Côte de Beaune".

Nineteenth-century authors, in their classifications, placed "Volnay" at the top of the hierarchy of the wines of Burgundy, citing several of its "climats" (customary name, most often the name of a lieu-dit) among the best. The "climats" "Caillerets" and "Santenots" are regularly singled out. The classification drawn up by the Comité de viticulture of the arrondissement of Beaune in 1860 gives a prominent place to the various "climats" of "Volnay".

The controlled designation of origin "Volnay" was recognised by a decree of 9 September 1937. In 1943 a list of "climats" that may benefit from the term "premier cru" was drawn up. These are the most renowned "crus", identified in particular in 1860.

The planting is based essentially on the pinot noir N variety. The vines are trained according to the usages in force in the "Côte de Beaune", notably with planting densities above 9,000 plants per hectare and Guyot pruning. It is customary to age the wines for a period of at least 8 months.

In 2008 the vineyard covered an area of about 210 hectares, of which 144 hectares are classified as "premier cru", for an average annual production of 7,700 hectolitres.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The wines display a ruby robe and are characterised on the palate by their great finesse, their tannic framework being balanced by a discreet acidity. Pleasant to drink in their youth, with their fruity

expression, they keep very well in bottle (10 years, or even 20 years for wines benefiting from the term "premier cru"), which reveals more complex notes of spice and game while preserving their elegance.

3° – Causal interactions

The cool oceanic climate, the topography of "the Côte", punctuated by combes and valleys, and the Jurassic marl and limestone soils combine to allow the optimal development of the pinot noir N variety, an indigenous Burgundian variety.

The exceptional quality of the natural site of "Volnay" has long been recognised. The general exposure towards the rising sun and the topographic position of the parcels delimited for the harvesting of the grapes give them particular mesoclimatic conditions, which protect them from the risks of frost and from morning mists while ensuring early warming of the soil. Producers have thus worked to preserve the image of these highly reputed wines, extending a heritage handed down from the time of the Dukes of Burgundy.

The relief, the geological diversity and the variety of soils that have developed favour in the wines a wide palette of nuances, which has long encouraged producers to distinguish the "climats" making up the wine-growing territory. These nuances show particularly well after a few years of keeping. The parcels of the "climats" situated on the "Dalle nacrée" limestones usually give wines of great elegance, with velvety tannins. The parcels of the "climats" situated higher on the slope, on a shallow marl substratum, give denser and very aromatic wines, as do in particular the parcels with soils developed on the clayey piedmont colluvium. This palette is highlighted, according to usage, by the indication on the label of the name of the "climat" from which the grapes come. The long ageing of the wines, while promoting a good aptitude for keeping in bottle, helps to reinforce the expression of this diversity, perceptible on tasting.

In 1816, JULLIEN, in his work "Topographie de tous les vignobles connus", classed the red wine of "Volnay" in the second class among the "fine wines" of Burgundy, describing it as "the lightest, the finest and the most pleasant of the Côte de Beaune". The classification of the Comité de viticulture of the arrondissement of Beaune in 1860 recorded about 215 hectares of "fine wine" vineyards, of which more than 90 hectares deserved the "1st class". This classification would guide the recognition of the future "climats" recognised under the term "premier cru".

In 1778, the Abbé COURTÉPÉE, in his "Description générale et particulière du Duché de Bourgogne", noted of the village of Volnay: "This village, in the most pleasant situation and the best disposition, produces the finest wines of the Beaune country, whence the proverb: there is only one Vollenay in France".

XI. – Transitional measures

No particular provision.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Volnay" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The name of a climat that may be associated with the term "premier cru" is placed immediately after the name of the controlled designation of origin and printed in characters whose dimensions, both

in height and in width, are not larger than those of the characters making up the name of the controlled designation of origin.

b) – The labelling of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, provided that:

- it is the name of a registered lieu-dit (cadastral locality);

- it appears on the harvest declaration.

The name of the registered lieu-dit is printed in characters whose dimensions, both in height and in width, are not larger than half those of the characters making up the name of the controlled designation of origin.

c) – The labelling of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the larger geographical unit “Vin de Bourgogne” or “Grand Vin de Bourgogne”.

d) – Where the grape variety is indicated on the labelling, this indication does not appear in the same field of vision as the compulsory particulars and is printed in characters whose dimensions do not exceed 2 millimetres.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before circulation between authorised warehousekeepers and at the latest on 10 December of the year of harvest.

It indicates in particular:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied in particular by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

2. Declaration prior to transaction and collections

Every operator wishing to sell in bulk a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes a transaction declaration for the lot concerned to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before any collection.

This declaration, accompanied where applicable by a copy of the purchase contract, specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the identification of the containers;

- the identity of the buyer.

If collections are made for volumes smaller than those set out in the transaction declaration, the operator informs the approved control body in writing.

3. Declaration of release for consumption

Every operator declares to the approved control body each lot of wine intended to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

This declaration may also be drawn up for lots already packaged. It is made within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before release for consumption or before the lots concerned are dispatched from the operator's cellars.

It specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the lot number for wines already packaged;

- the identification of the containers for non-packaged wines.

However, making available to the approved control body the register referred to in Article D. 645-18 II of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code serves as the declaration of release for consumption, under the conditions set out in the control plan.

4. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to dispatch outside the national territory a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin declares it to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before any dispatch.

5. Fallback declaration

Every operator carrying out a fallback of a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin into a more general controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the approved control body a monthly declaration at the latest on the 1st working day following the tenth day of each month.

This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the more general controlled designation of origin of the fallback;

- the volume concerned by the fallback;

- the vintage;

- the state of the lot concerned (bulk, bottle, hermetically sealed vacuum containers…);

- the date of the fallback.

The approved control body transmits without delay a copy of the monthly declaration to the approved control body for the more general controlled designation of origin concerned.

The defence and management body transmits without delay to the defence and management body of the more general controlled designation of origin concerned the list of operators who have made a monthly fallback declaration, together with a summary statement indicating:

- the more general controlled designation of origin of the fallback;

- the volume concerned by the fallback;

- the vintage(s);

- the state of the lot(s) concerned (bulk, bottle, hermetically sealed vacuum containers…).

6. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the approved control body a monthly declaration within time limits set in the control plan. This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the volume downgraded;

- the vintage;

- the date of the downgrading.

7. Declaration of equipment for TSE

Every operator holding a concentration apparatus declares it upon purchase to the defence and management body, specifying its specifications. The defence and management body keeps an up-to-date list of operators holding such equipment and sends it each year to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the latest on 1 September.

Every operator using a service provider declares it to the defence and management body, which draws up the list of these operators and sends it each year to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the latest on 1 September.

8. Reworking of parcels

Before any development or any works liable to modify the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer (including any addition of exogenous soil) or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works, the operator sends a declaration to the defence and management body at least four weeks before the planned start date of the works.

The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

II. – Keeping of registers

1. General plan of the storage and vinification places

Every vinifying operator keeps up to date and available for the approved control body a general plan of the storage and vinification places, allowing in particular the number, designation and capacity of the containers to be identified.

2. TSE register

Every operator carrying out partial concentration of musts keeps an up-to-date TSE register including in particular:

- the initial volume;

- the volume of water evaporated;

- the identification of the lot after concentration (volume and potential alcoholic strength).

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Location of operators within the immediate proximity area	Documentary check
A2 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	– Documentary check: up-to-date CVI parcel record; – Check in the field
A3 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, planting density, plant material)	– Documentary check; – Check in the field
A4 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities	
Vat capacity	– Documentary check: general plan of the storage places; – On-site check
Ageing (temperature control and length of ageing)	– Documentary check: declaration of release for consumption or bottling register; – On-site check
State of upkeep of the cellar and equipment (hygiene)	On-site check
Protected storage place and storage conditions (T °C)	On-site check
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard	
Pruning	Check in the field
Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
Cultivation and sanitary condition of the vine (sanitary condition of foliage and berries, upkeep of the soil, upkeep of the trellising)	Check in the field
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes	
Harvest	Check in the field
Ripeness of the grapes	– Documentary check: records of ripeness monitoring; – Check in the field
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage	

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices…)	– Documentary check: declaration of equipment and TSE register, enrichment, acidification and de-acidification register; – On-site check
Stock accounts, analytical traceability	Documentary check: keeping of registers, analysis reports
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Missing vines	– Documentary check (keeping the list up to date); – Check in the field
Authorised yield	Documentary check: check of declarations, monitoring of authorisations granted by the INAO services after their investigation of the operator's individual request
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield	Documentary check: monitoring of destruction certificates
Claim declaration	– Documentary and on-site check: compliance with procedures and time limits, consistency with the harvest and production declarations; – Check of the release of products into circulation
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines (at transaction or collection)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Packaged wines (before or after preparation for release for consumption)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all lots
D – PRESENTATION OF THE PRODUCTS	
Labelling	On-site check

II. – References concerning the control structure

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Compliance with the present specification is checked on the basis of an approved control plan, by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence that has received delegation from the INAO.